

CHAPTER 7

Madam Rides the Bus

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡
answers are samples: write your own.

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⭐ Let's Begin

1 **In the story 'Madam Rides the Bus', Valli took a bus ride on the bus that she wanted to for last several months. She knew that she had to buy tickets for this. So she saved money suppressing all temptation to buy things like peppermints, toys, balloons, etc., and paid for the ticket.**

• What all exciting things did she see from the bus?

• Was the excitement the same on her return journey?

Discuss with your classmate and write a paragraph based on your discussion on the above mentioned questions.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Valli's Bus Ride

From the bus Valli saw many exciting things. The bus went along the bank of a canal with palm trees, grassland, distant mountains and the "blue, blue sky" on one side, and acres of green fields on the other. It rushed past tiny hamlets and wayside shops, and trees seemed to come running towards the bus. A young cow ran in front of the bus and made her laugh till she had tears in her eyes. She saw a train rush past a railway crossing with a roar, and in town she gaped at big bright shops, glittering displays of clothes and big crowds.

On the way back, she was excited at first and enjoyed the same sights. But when she saw the same young cow lying dead by the roadside, she was overcome with sadness. The memory haunted her, and she no longer wanted to look out of the window. So the excitement of the return journey was not the same.

2 **Have you undertaken any journey by bicycle, boat, bus, train, or on an elephant back? Share your experience with your friends in the class.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Last winter I went by train from Delhi to Haridwar with my family. I sat by the window and watched green fields, small stations and children waving at the train. Vendors sold hot tea and snacks. At Haridwar we saw the evening aarti on the Ganga. It was a journey I will never forget.

⭐ Reading Comprehension · Text I (Pedalling through the Golden Years)

Q.1 **What is the meaning of the expression "when our peers were slowing down, relaxing and watching sunsets from their front porch" and in what context has the author used this?**

✔ ANSWER

It means that people of their age (their peers) were living a quiet, restful life after retirement, doing very little. The author uses it to show the contrast: at the same age, she and her husband found a new, active passion — cycling.

Q.2 **What made Vishav and her husband confident to venture into Uttarakhand on their bicycles?**

✔ ANSWER

They had lived in Dehradun, Uttarakhand's capital, all their lives. So they were **acclimatised** to the cold winds and narrow winding roads, and knew almost all the scenic mountain trails. Their success in short rides and cyclothons, and encouragement from family, friends and neighbours also gave them confidence.

Q.3 **What was the strong passion that prompted the retired couple to take up this adventurous journey?**

✔ ANSWER

Their passion was **cycling**. They fell in love not just with the sport but with the idea of discovering the world of Uttarakhand, which they had always been a part of but never had time to explore.

Q.4 **What, according to the author, is the most thrilling way to enjoy and appreciate Uttarakhand? Why does she say so?**

✔ ANSWER

According to the author, **cycling** is the most thrilling way. As you ride, sunlight filters through the trees, a cool breeze caresses your face, and you get breathtaking views of sal forests on the mountains and valleys. This experience is "truly inexplicable".

Q.5 **Which trail occupies a special place in the couple's heart?**

✔ ANSWER

The trail from **Ghanta Ghar** in Dehradun through Kimadi, Hathi Paon, Mussoorie and Chaar Dukaan right up to **George Everest point** — a ride of about 100 km.

Q.6 **What are the expectations of a cyclist from such an adventurous trip through the mountains? Did Vishav and Kamal Jeet get these experiences from the 100 km ride?**

✔ ANSWER

A cyclist in the mountains expects steep slopes, sharp curves, endless hills, lush forests and off-road experiences.

Yes, they got all these on their 100 km ride, because this route "encapsulates all the elements" that one expects while cycling in Uttarakhand.

⭐ Reading Comprehension · Text II (Going Down Hill on a Bicycle)

Q.1 **The poem describes the _____ of going downhill on a bicycle.**

(a) enjoyment
(b) happiness
(c) excitement
(d) satisfaction

✔ ANSWER

(c) excitement — the boy darts down "swifter and yet more swift", his heart lifts and he feels he is flying like a bird.

Q.2 **Which line(s) depict the freedom like that of a bird that the poet enjoys?**

✔ ANSWER

"O bird, see; see, bird, I fly."

"O bird, then I, though a boy, / For a golden moment share / Your feathery life in air!"

Q.3 **Which is the experience the boy is sharing with the bird? What is the golden moment he is referring to?**

✔ ANSWER

The boy shares the bird's experience of **flying freely in the air** — the joy of speed and lightness.

The golden moment is the short, precious time when he rushes down the hill on his bicycle with lifted feet and feels as if he is flying.

Q.4 **What is the meaning of 'full of bliss' here? Can the boy find this kind of bliss in the world where he lives?**

✔ ANSWER

'Full of bliss' means full of great joy and happiness.

The boy asks his heart if anything in this joyful world is like this ride. He feels nothing else gives this kind of bliss — it is even "more than skating". So such bliss is rare; he finds it only in this downhill ride.

Q.5 **There is a comparison in the third stanza. What is it?**

✔ ANSWER

The boy compares himself with a **bird**. Going down the hill on his bicycle, he feels he is flying like a bird: "O bird, then I, though a boy, / For a golden moment share / Your feathery life in air!"

(In the next stanza he also says the ride is "more than skating" on level ground.)

Q.6 **What is the meaning of the last two lines of the poem? Does "toil" mean dedication, determination, and will power to climb the hill? What is the reward here?**

✔ ANSWER

"Who climbs with toil, wheresoe'er, / Shall find wings waiting there" means that whoever works hard to climb a hill (or face any difficulty in life) will be rewarded with joy and freedom at the top.

Yes, "toil" here means hard work done with dedication, determination and will power.

The reward is the “wings” — the thrilling, free, bird-like ride down the hill, i.e. success and happiness after hard work.

⭐ Vocabulary

1 **Find out the words from the text ‘Madam Rides the Bus’ that match with the given meanings.**

(a) inquisitive

(b) intricate

(c) mesmerizing

(d) immense

(e) hardly

✔ ANSWER

(a) inquisitive — **curious** (“very curious about things”)

(b) intricate — **elaborate** (“elaborate games”, “elaborate plans”)

(c) mesmerizing — **fascinating** (“The most fascinating thing of all”)

(d) immense — **tremendous** (“a tremendous roar and rattle”)

(e) hardly — **scarcely** (“who scarcely saw that much money”)

⭐ Grammar

1 **Complete each sentence using a verb from box A and a word from box B (by making a phrasal verb). Use the correct form of the verb wherever necessary.**

A: break, drive, get, fill, wake, turn

B: out, down, off, on, in, up

(a) It was evening. She _____ the light.

(b) Do not _____ Ramesh. He was studying late at night yesterday.

(c) The school bus _____ and had to be towed to the garage for repair.

(d) They got in the car and _____.

(e) She hurt herself as she was _____ of the car.

(f) You have to _____ the form yourself.

✔ ANSWER

(a) It was evening. She **turned on** the light.

(b) Do not **wake up** Ramesh. He was studying late at night yesterday.

(c) The school bus **broke down** and had to be towed to the garage for repair.

(d) They got in the car and **drove off**.

(e) She hurt herself as she was **getting out** of the car.

(f) You have to **fill in** (fill up) the form yourself.

⭐ Editing

1 **Use capital letters and full stops wherever necessary and correct the spelling errors as well, in the following paragraph.**

An exciting boat journey gliding crosswise the river from Godkhali jetty will take to a place of incredible mystic beauty of Nature.

The sundarbans a unesco World Heritage Site is located at the South eastern tip of the 24 Paraganas district about 110 km from Kolkata it got its name from one of the mangrov plants known as Sundari (Heritiera Minor) Sundrbans are a part of the world's largest delta, formed by the mighty rivers ganga, brahmaputra and meghna it is one of the most attractive and alluring places remaining on earth, a truly undiscovered paradise the Sundarbans is the largest singl block of tidal, halophytic mangrove forests in the world. It is the largest tiger reserv and National Park

apart from being a unique largest mangrove eco-system of the world, the sundarbns has the world's largest deltaic mangroove forests and is also home to one of India's most iconic wildlife species - the royal bengal Ttger. The Sundarbans also serves as a crusial protective barrier for the inhabitents in and around Kolkata against the floods that result from the cyclones which are a regular occurrence. The Sundarbans have also been enlisted amongst the finalists in the New 7 Wonders of Nature.

✔ ANSWER

An exciting boat journey gliding crosswise the river from Godkhali jetty will take you to a place of incredible mystic beauty of Nature.

The **Sundarbans**, a **UNESCO** World Heritage Site, is located at the **south-eastern** tip of the 24 **Parganas** district, about 110 km from Kolkata**. It** got its name from one of the **mangrove** plants known as Sundari (Heritiera **minor**)**. Sundarbans** are a part of the world's largest delta, formed by the mighty rivers **Ganga**, **Brahmaputra** and **Meghna**. **It** is one of the most attractive and alluring places remaining on earth, a truly undiscovered paradise. **The** Sundarbans is the largest **single** block of tidal, halophytic mangrove forests in the world. It is the largest tiger **reserve** and National Park.

Apart from being a unique largest mangrove eco-system of the world, the **Sundarbans** has the world's largest deltaic **mangrove** forests and is also home to one of India's most iconic wildlife species — the **Royal Bengal Tiger**. The Sundarbans also serves as a **crucial** protective barrier for the **inhabitants** in and around Kolkata against the floods that result from the cyclones which are a regular occurrence. The Sundarbans have also been enlisted amongst the finalists in the New 7 Wonders of Nature.

Spelling corrections: mangrov → mangrove, Sundrbans → Sundarbans, singl → single, reserv → reserve, sundarbns → Sundarbans, mangroove → mangrove, Ttger → Tiger, crusial → crucial, inhabitents → inhabitants (Paraganas → Parganas).

Capitals: Sundarbans, UNESCO, Ganga, Brahmaputra, Meghna, Royal Bengal Tiger, and the first word of each new sentence (It, Sundarbans, It, The, Apart).

⭐ Listening (Mizoram)

1 **The land of Mizo is a large open area of _____. The hills are _____ and _____.**

✔ ANSWER

The land of Mizo is a large open area of **blue-green hills**. The hills are **rugged** and **their heights uneven** (uneven in height).

2 **The state referred here is made of two names —**

(a) 'Mi' means _____.

(b) 'Zo' means _____.

(c) and Mizoram means _____.

✔ ANSWER

(a) 'Mi' means **human beings**.

(b) ‘Zo’ means **a hill**.

(c) and Mizoram means **the land of the hill-dwellers**.

3 **Which activities are associated with Mizo festivals? How do Mizos enjoy these festivals?**

✔ ANSWER

The three main festivals — Mim Kut, Chapchar Kut and Pawl Kut — are associated with their **agricultural activities**. The Mizos enjoy these festivals by **singing and dancing**.

4 **What are the special features of a Mizo dance?**

✔ ANSWER

- They are folk and community dances handed down from one generation to the next.
- They express the gay, carefree spirit of the Mizos.
- They are not meant for stage performance; they have evolved for community involvement and participation.

5 **The following statements characterise Mizo people. Tick the one which is not true.**

(a) Mizos have a beautiful culture.

(b) They live in a beautiful natural environment.

(c) They are a protective people.

(d) They are a vibrant people.

(e) They love to dance and not so much to sing.

(f) They have a number of community and folk dances.

(g) The community involvement and participation is always there.

✔ ANSWER

Not true: **(e) They love to dance and not so much to sing.** — the passage says “They love to dance as much as they love to sing.”

(c) is also not stated: the passage calls them a “vibrant and **social**” people, not a protective people.

(a), (b), (d), (f) and (g) are true.

⭐ Speaking

1 **Read Part II of the story 'Madam Rides the Bus'. Convert the conversations into dialogues between the characters, then in groups of three, enact it as a skit in the class.**

Valli (loudly): Stop the bus! Stop the bus!

Conductor (without looking up): Who is it? Hurry then!

Valli (loudly): It's me, I am the one who has to get on the bus.

Conductor (smilingly): Oh. really! _____

Valli (commandingly): I have to _____ Here is _____.

Valli (smartly): I can _____

Conductor (jokingly): Oh, please _____

A voice (anxiously): Listen, child _____

Valli (haughtily): There is nobody _____

Conductor (smilingly): Oh, sir _____

Valli (angrily): I am _____

Conductor (mimicking her): _____

Valli (steadfastly): Because I _____

A voice (with concern): If you _____

Valli (irritably): I'm not _____

✔ ANSWER

Conductor (smilingly): Oh, really! You don't say so!

Valli (commandingly): I have to go to town. Here is my money.

(Conductor stretched out his hand to help her up.)

Valli (smartly): I can get on by myself. You don't have to help me.

Conductor (jokingly): Oh, please don't be angry with me, my fine madam. Have a seat right up there in front. Everybody move aside, please — make way for madam.

A voice (anxiously): Listen, child, you shouldn't stand like that. Sit down.

Valli (haughtily): There is nobody here who's a child. I've paid my thirty paise like everyone else.

Conductor (smilingly): Oh, sir, but this is a very grown-up madam. Do you think a mere girl could pay her own fare and travel to the city all alone?

Valli (angrily): I am not a madam. Please remember that. And you've not yet given me my ticket.

Conductor (mimicking her): I'll remember. Just sit back and make yourself comfortable. Why should you stand when you've paid for a seat?

Valli (steadfastly): Because I want to.

A voice (with concern): If you stand on the seat, you may fall and hurt yourself when the bus makes a sharp turn or hits a bump. That's why we want you to sit down, child.

Valli (irritably): I'm not a child, I tell you. I'm eight years old.

2 · Task I

Communicative Task I (Offering, accepting and refusing help) — Pair or Group Work

Write conversations like the one above imagining you are in the classroom. Use the clues given below: Excuse me... / Yes? / I wonder if you could lend me your dictionary. I'm doing my class work. / I'm sorry. I'm using it right now. May be later. / That's okay. Thanks anyway.

Write similar conversations imagining you are in the following situations: in the kitchen; at the railway station; asking somebody to open the door; in a hospital; in the playground.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

In the classroom

Ravi: Excuse me, Neha.

Neha: Yes?

Ravi: I wonder if you could lend me your dictionary. I'm doing my class work.

Neha: I'm sorry. I'm using it right now. Maybe later.

Ravi: That's okay. Thanks anyway.

In the kitchen

Son: Mummy, you look busy. Can I help you chop the vegetables?

Mother: Thank you, dear, but I've almost finished. You could set the table, though.

Son: Sure, I'll do it right away.

At the railway station

Passenger: Excuse me, could you help me lift this heavy bag onto the train?

Student: Of course. Let me hold it from this side.

Passenger: Thank you so much. That's very kind of you.

Asking somebody to open the door

Aman: Excuse me, could you please open the door? My hands are full.

Peon: Certainly. Here you are.

Aman: Thanks a lot.

In a hospital

Visitor: Excuse me, nurse. Could you tell me where Ward 5 is?

Nurse: I'm sorry, I'm on duty here. Please ask at the reception.

Visitor: That's all right. Thank you anyway.

In the playground

Raju: You look tired. Shall I carry the cricket kit for you?

Sameer: Thanks, but I can manage. It's not very heavy.

Raju: Fine. Let me know if you need help.

2 · Task II

Communicative Task II (Asking for information, indirect questions and question tags) — Pair or Group work

Using the above piece as a model, ask for information, make requests and give your opinion regarding — the floods in Chennai, 'Cyberabad' (Hyderabad), a celebration in your school, a landslide during the Amarnath yatra, etc.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The floods in Chennai

Anu: Could you tell me what happened in Chennai last week?

Vikram: There were heavy floods after days of rain.

Anu: The rain was very heavy, wasn't it?

Vikram: Yes, it was. Many roads and houses were under water.

Anu: The rescue teams worked hard, didn't they?

Vikram: They certainly did. But I think the drains should be cleaned before the monsoon, shouldn't they?

Anu: I agree. Planning can save many lives.

A celebration in your school

Riya: Could you please tell me when the Annual Day is?

Tarun: It's next Saturday. You are taking part in the dance, aren't you?

Riya: Yes, I am. The chief guest is the District Collector, isn't he?

Tarun: I think so. It will be a grand event, won't it?

Riya: Surely. I hope it doesn't rain.

⭐ Writing

1 **In the text, seeing Valli travelling alone in the bus, some of the characters showed concerns: "Are you alone, dear?"; "Won't your mother be looking for you?"; "Is it proper for such a young person to travel alone? Do you exactly know where you're going in town? What's the street? What's the house number?"**

Do you think that the concerns of the elderly lady and the conductor are apt and genuine? Will you say that it is applicable to young boys as well? Discuss in groups, make note and then arrange a debate competition. Then write a paragraph considering these issues and give your opinion as well.

Points: • Girls and boys of Valli's age can travel alone in a bus or auto rickshaw, etc. • Freedom should be given to them to move around. • Safety of the young children is of utmost concern. • What type of education should be given to them? • This is a vulnerable age and children are innocent.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Should Young Children Travel Alone?

The concerns of the elderly woman and the conductor were apt and genuine. Valli was only eight years old. She had slipped out without telling her mother, and nobody knew where she was. If she had got lost or met a wrong person, she could have been in serious danger. This concern applies equally to young boys, because at this age all children are innocent and vulnerable.

Children do need some freedom to move around, as it makes them confident and independent, like Valli. But this freedom should come step by step and with the knowledge of parents. Safety must come first. Children should be taught their full address and parents' phone numbers, road-safety rules, the helpline numbers 112 and 1098, and not to accept food or lifts from strangers. In my opinion, children of Valli's age should not travel alone; they may travel with a trusted adult until they are old enough to handle emergencies.

2 **You have read that on her return journey, Valli saw the young cow lying dead by the roadside. This young cow was running very fast in front of the bus and had given Valli unbound happiness when she was travelling to the town. Now, write a paragraph on 'Should the domestic animals be let loose to walk on the roads freely' where the vehicles are plying? Who is responsible for the death of the young cow?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Stray Animals on Roads

Domestic animals should not be let loose on roads where vehicles are plying. Cows, buffaloes and dogs wandering on roads cause traffic jams and serious accidents in which both animals and people get hurt or killed. Frightened by horns, animals often run in front of vehicles, as the young cow did in the story. The young cow's death was the fault of both its careless owner, who let it roam freely on the highway, and the fast-moving vehicle whose driver did not slow down. Owners must keep their animals tied or in sheds, local bodies should set up cattle shelters, and drivers must drive carefully on village roads. A little care can save innocent lives.

🛠️ Project

1 **Read the quick tips for travelling by a bike (proper frame and tyres, hand pump, extra tubes, puncture kit, gloves, helmet, knee and elbow pads, shoes, dry food, water, ORS, first-aid kit). Now, prepare a list of things that you would like to suggest to people who want to travel by:**

(a) a train

(b) a bus

(c) a boat

(d) a motorbike

(e) on foot (for example a trek)

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

(a) **Train:** confirmed ticket and ID proof, PNR noted, light luggage with a lock and chain, water bottle and dry snacks, a light shawl or bedsheet, charged phone and power bank, medicines, helpline 139.

(b) **Bus:** ticket and some change for the fare, small bag, water, medicine for motion sickness, a window seat if you feel sick, keep valuables with you, note the bus number.

(c) **Boat:** life jacket (always wear it), waterproof bag for phone and documents, cap and sunscreen, water, sit still and do not lean over the side, travel only in licensed boats.

(d) **Motorbike:** helmet (for both riders), driving licence, RC and insurance papers, check fuel, brakes, tyres and lights, gloves and jacket, rain-coat, tool kit, follow speed limits.

(e) **On foot / trek:** good walking shoes, a light backpack, water, ORS and dry food (nuts, chocolates), cap, torch, map or guide, first-aid kit, warm clothes, whistle; trek in a group and tell someone your route.

2 A **Copies of some tickets are given here. Collect some more train tickets, bus tickets, flight tickets, platform tickets, entry tickets for the zoo, cinema hall, metro rail etc.**

- **Make a collage.**
- **Study the information given in these tickets.**
- **Draw a table to enter the information like PNR number, time of departure, time of arrival, confirmed ticket, wait-listed ticket, RAC status in train, seat number, food preferences, price of the ticket, number of passengers, etc.**
- **How are these tickets different from each other?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Make the collage with your own tickets. A sample table (fill in from your tickets):

Ticket	Number / PNR	From – To	Departure / Arrival	Status / Seat	Passengers	Price
Train	PNR 4521367890	Delhi – Agra	06:00 / 07:45	Confirmed, C1-23	2	₹ 1,050
Bus	012345	Village – Town	13:00 / 13:45	Seat 7	1	₹ 30
Flight	PNR ABC123	Delhi – Mumbai	09:10 / 11:20	Seat 14A, veg meal	1	₹ 5,400
Metro	Token	Rajiv Chowk – Dwarka	—	—	1	₹ 40
Zoo entry	0789	—	Valid for one day	—	3	₹ 120

How they differ: train and flight tickets have a PNR, seat/berth number, status (confirmed, RAC, wait-listed) and timings; flight tickets show baggage and meal preference; bus, metro and platform tickets are short and give only fare and route/date; entry tickets give the place, date and number of persons.

2 B **Write a paragraph on 'Why it is essential to travel with a ticket?'**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Why It Is Essential to Travel with a Ticket

Travelling with a ticket is our duty as honest citizens. The money from tickets helps the government and transport companies to run buses and trains, pay their staff and keep the vehicles safe and clean. A ticket is also proof that we are genuine passengers; it gives us the right to a seat and, in case of an accident, helps in getting insurance and compensation. Travelling without a ticket is an offence, and the traveller can be fined, made to get off or even sent to jail. It also brings shame to oneself and one's family. Even little Valli in 'Madam Rides the Bus' saved her money and proudly said, "I've got a ticket too." We should all follow her example and always travel with a valid ticket.

🎉 **Chapter 7 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**